

FOCUS AREAS

- Computer-Supported Cooperative Work
- Computer-Mediated Communication
- AI-Mediated Communication and Collaboration

EDUCATION

University of Washington

Ph.D. in Human Centered Design & Engineering (HCI)

Advisors: Prof. David McDonald and Prof. Mark Zachry

Seattle, WA, USA

Sep 2023 - 2028 (expected)

Seoul National University

M.S. in Engineering, Intelligence & Information (HCI)

Advisor: Prof. Joongseek Lee

Seoul, South Korea

Sep 2019 - Feb 2022

Thesis: *Study on Remote Studying Activity with Video Conferencing Tool to Feel the Presence of Others: Focusing on Revealing and Hiding Themselves through Videos*

Ewha Womans University

B.A. in Communication & Media

B.A. in International Studies (conc. in Business and Economics)

Seoul, South Korea

Mar 2013 - Feb 2019

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Investigating LLM-Assisted Participant Profiles for Sensemaking in Wikipedia Discussions , Lead Researcher	ongoing
Investigating LLM-Assisted Community Norm Guidance for Sensemaking in Wikipedia Discussions , Lead Researcher	ongoing
Examining Students' Use of LLMs for Interpersonal Communication in Academic Settings [P5, N5] , Principal Investigator	ongoing
Exploring LLM-Assisted Information Restructuring for Sensemaking in Wikipedia Discussions [under review, N6] , Lead Researcher	2026
Understanding How LLMs Impact Participation in Knowledge Communities with a Focus on Wikipedia [R4] , Research Assistant	2025
Applying Existing Design Recommendations to AI Companion Design [R5] , Lead Researcher	2025
Exploring Short-Lived AI Companion Chatbots through Collaborative Autoethnography [P4] , Lead Researcher	2024
Examining Wikipedian Views on Key Elements for LLM-Generated Discussion Summaries [R3] , Lead Researcher	2024
Designing to Protect Privacy and Reduce Fear for Teens on Social Media [R2] , Research Assistant	2024
Designing a Video Conferencing Interface for Virtual Co-Studying [P3] , Lead Researcher	2022
Understanding Virtual Co-Studying Practices via Video Conferencing [R1] , Lead Researcher	2022

Designing a Knowledge-Sharing Chatbot for Residents of Single-Person Housing [P2, N2], Lead Researcher	2021
Understanding Conversations with Smart Speakers in Single-Person Households [N3], Lead Researcher	2021
Investigating Information Needs for Awareness between Remote Workers [P1], Lead Researcher	2020
Investigating Auditory Cues for Separateness of AI Speaker Services [N1], Lead Researcher	2019

PUBLICATIONS

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- [R5] **Soobin Cho**, Deveshi Modi, Divya Mavinkurve, Jieqiong Ding, and Mark Zachry. 2027. Assessing the applicability of existing design recommendations to AI companion design: A multi-method study. *International Journal of Human-Computer Studies* 218 (2027), 103940. doi:10.1016/j.ijhcs.2026.103940 (arXiv:2609.14236)
- [R4] Moyan Zhou, **Soobin Cho**, and Loren Terveen. 2026. LLMs in Wikipedia: Investigating How LLMs Impact Participation in Knowledge Communities. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 10, 6, Article CSCW116 (October 2026), 20 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3816964>
- [R3] **Soobin Cho**, Mark Zachry, and David W. McDonald. 2025. Towards Insider Summarization for Mediation Instead of Moderation: Examining Wikipedian Views on Key Elements of Discussion Summaries. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 9, 7, Article CSCW500 (November 2025), 25 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757681>
- [R2] JaeWon Kim, **Soobin Cho**, Robert Wolfe, Jishnu Hari Nair, and Alexis Hiniker. 2025. Privacy as Social Norm: Systematically Empowering Teen Privacy Management on Social Media. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 9, 2, Article CSCW151 (April 2025), 39 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3711049>
- [R1] **Soobin Cho**, Joongseek Lee, and Bongwon Suh. 2023. “I Want to Reveal, but I Also Want to Hide” Understanding the Conflict of Revealing and Hiding Needs in Virtual Study Rooms. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 7, CSCW2, Article 300 (October 2023), 27 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3610091>

PEER-REVIEWED POSTERS AND EXTENDED ABSTRACTS

- [P5] Jared Ren and **Soobin Cho**. 2026. “ChatGPT, Review This Message to My Prof” Investigating Students’ Use of AI for Online Communication in Academic Settings. In *Companion of the Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW Companion ’26)*, October 10–14, 2026, Salt Lake City, UT, USA. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 7 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3785651.3831512>
- [P4] **Soobin Cho**, Anna Lindner, Joseph S. Schafer, Pitch Sinlapantakul, Julie A. Vera, and Mark Zachry. 2025. Collaborative Autoethnography as a Method to Explore Short-Lived Social AI Chatbots. In *13th International Conference on Human-Agent Interaction (HAI ’25)*, November 10–13, 2025, Yokohama, Japan. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 3 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3765766.3765830>
- [P3] **Soobin Cho**, Bongwon Suh, and Joongseek Lee. 2022. “Hide Your Video, Show Your Action!” Investigating a New Video Conferencing Interface for Virtual Studying. In *Companion Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW’22 Companion)*, November 08–22, 2022, Virtual Event, Taiwan. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 5 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3500868.3559451>
- [P2] Sang Ah Park, Yoon Young Lee, **Soobin Cho**, Minjoon Kim, and Joongseek Lee. 2021. “Knock Knock, Here Is an Answer from Next Door”: Designing a Knowledge Sharing Chatbot to Connect Residents: Community Chatbot Design Case Study. In *Companion Publication of the 2021 Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW ’21 Companion)*, October 23–27, 2021, Virtual Event, USA. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 5 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3462204.3481738>

- [P1] **Soobin Cho**, Bongwon Suh, and Joongseek Lee. 2020. Not Too Much, Nor Too Less: Investigating Which Information Should Be Shared for Awareness Between Remote Workers. In *Companion Publication of the 2020 Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW '20 Companion)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 239–243. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3406865.3418308>

NON-PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- [N6] **Soobin Cho**, Mark Zachry, and David W. McDonald. 2026. How Much Can AI Understand? Toward AI-Assisted Sensemaking of Collaborative Discussion in Groups with Shared History. [arXiv:2608.27799](https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.27799) [cs.HC] (accepted at 2026 **CSCW workshop 'Broader Impacts of GenAI in Communication'**)
- [N5] Jared Ren and **Soobin Cho**. 2026. Delegating Before Learning: Where Generative AI Sits in Students' Professional Communication. [arXiv:2608.28837](https://arxiv.org/abs/2608.28837) [cs.HC] (accepted at 2026 **CSCW workshop 'Broader Impacts of GenAI in Communication'**)
- [N4] **Soobin Cho**, Mark Zachry, and David W. McDonald. 2025. A Framework for AI-Supported Mediation in Community-based Online Collaboration. [arXiv:2509.10015](https://arxiv.org/abs/2509.10015) [cs.HC] (accepted at 2025 **CSCW workshop 'Augmenting Collaborative Problem-Solving: Exploring the Design and Use of GenAI for Groupwork'**)
- [N3] **Soobin Cho**, Yoon Young Lee, Sang Ah Park, and Joongseek Lee. 2021. "Can Smart Speaker Be the 'SimSimi' for Single Households?": Study on the Use of Smart Speakers by Single Households. In *Proceedings of HCI Korea 2021*. The HCI Society of Korea, 6 pages. [dbpia]
- [N2] Sang Ah Park, **Soobin Cho**, Yoon Young Lee, and Joongseek Lee. 2021. 'Naver Knowledge-iN' in a Speaker: Designing a Voice-Based Knowledge Sharing Service. In *Proceedings of HCI Korea 2021*. The HCI Society of Korea, 6 pages. [dbpia]
- [N1] **Soobin Cho** and Joongseek Lee. 2020. Study on Auditory Cues for Conversation Separateness in AI Speaker Multi-Turn Services. In *Proceedings of HCI Korea 2020*. The HCI Society of Korea, 4 pages. [dbpia]

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

DIRECTED RESEARCH GROUPS, University of Washington

- | | |
|--|-------------|
| Understanding Online Community Norms to Build an AI Agent (2) | Winter 2026 |
| Directed 8 students to create training datasets for norm-aware AI agents as an extension of the research group project. | |
| Understanding Online Community Norms to Build an AI Agent (1) | Fall 2025 |
| Directed 6 students in understanding and labeling Wikipedia policy application cases to create training datasets for norm-aware AI agents. | |
| Design Principles for AI Companions (2) | Winter 2025 |
| Directed 3 students in conducting thematic analysis of over 400 design recommendations and performing internal and external heuristic evaluations to develop design principles. | |
| Design Principles for AI Companions (1) | Fall 2024 |
| Directed 11 students in experiencing diverse AI companions, conducting user research, and applying over 500 design recommendations from related fields through guided discussions. | |

TEACHING ASSISTANT

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|---|------------------------|
| HCDE 518: User-Centered Design , University of Washington | Fall 2026 |
| HCID 510: Designing Interactive Systems , University of Washington | Spring 2026 |
| HCDE 501: Theoretical Foundations of HCDE , University of Washington | Fall 2025, Winter 2026 |
| HCDE 593: Master's Capstone , University of Washington | Spring 2025 |
| HCDE 592: Master's Capstone Planning , University of Washington | Winter 2025 |
| HCDE 519: Qualitative Research Methods , University of Washington | Fall 2024 |
| HCDE 300: Foundations of HCDE , University of Washington | Spring 2024 |
| Information Technology Practice , Seoul National University | Spring 2020, Fall 2020 |

WORK EXPERIENCE

Soft Berry Inc.

UX Researcher, Product Team

Korean Series A startup (\$8M+ funding), operates Korea's leading EV charging station app

- First and sole UX researcher, led end-to-end research strategy and execution.
- Ran mixed-methods studies: interviews, contextual inquiries, surveys, workshops, usage log analysis, and market/competitive research.
- Partnered with leadership (CEO, COO, PM Lead) to align goals and convert insights into product principles and design guidelines.
- Collaborated with designers and engineers to implement findings in the app.
- Shared research outcomes across the organization through presentations and reports.

Seoul, South Korea

Mar 2022 - Aug 2023

Weber Shandwick

Junior Associate, Consumer Marketing Team

- Clients: Netflix, Burger King, American Airlines, Ocean Spray
- Planned and executed digital and print PR campaigns, conducted performance analyses, and supported crisis management.

Seoul, South Korea

Sep 2017 - Oct 2018

HONORS AND AWARDS

Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award, University of Washington

Fall 2025

Publication Achievement Award, Seoul National University

Fall 2021

Brain Korea 21 Four Scholarship, Ministry of Education, Korea

Fall 2020, Spring 2021

Brain Korea 21 Plus Scholarship, Ministry of Education, Korea

Fall 2019, Spring 2020

Honors Scholarship, Ewha Womans University

Fall 2013, Fall 2014, Fall 2015, Spring 2017

Dean's List, Ewha Womans University

Spring 2013, Spring 2014, Fall 2014, Fall 2016, Spring 2017

INVITED TALKS AND LECTURES

HCID 590 (Design, Use, Build Seminar): Guest Lecture

Oct 2025

HCDE 545 (Qualitative Research Methods): Guest Session on Qualitative Analysis

May 2025

HCI Korea 2020 (Tutorial Session): *Making 'Cool' Voice Service*

Aug 2020

REVIEW SERVICE

ACM CSCW

2023 - 2026

ACM CHI

2025 - 2026

Special Recognition for Outstanding Reviews (CHI 2026, 2 papers)

ACM CHI Late-Breaking Work

2022 - 2026

Special Recognition for Outstanding Reviews (CHI 2025 LBW)

ACM CUI Short Papers

2025 - 2026

Wiki Workshop

2026